

Asian Industrial Technology

Asian Industrial Tech: The Barometer (April/May 2026)



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In April and May, China FA continued to grow at near-peak rate. In the RoW, the recovery further accelerated. Readers can download the complete barometer data set here: [Global Industrial Barometer](#).

We highlight three datasets for China: 1) In May, the official manufacturing PMI and the PMI for production remained in expansion levels at 50.0 (was 50.3, Exhibit 2), 51.2 (was 51.5); PMI for new orders slightly declined to 49.9 (was 50.6, Exhibit 4). More relevant to factory automation, PMI for high-tech manufacturing and equipment manufacturing further expanded to 52.9 (was 52.2) and 52.1 (was 51.8). 2) In April, Japan's machine tool orders from China continued to grow strongly YoY (+33.2% YoY in April vs. +27.2% YoY in March, excluding FX effects, Exhibit 17), and the strength remains broad-based (Exhibit 18). The "twin peaks" pattern, similar to previous cycles, is forming. 3) In April, industrial profits growth further accelerated, reaching 24.7% YoY (Exhibit 7), driven by accelerated revenue growth and improved operating margin. In 4M26, the manufacturing sector, particularly the high-end manufacturing segment, outperformed the overall industrial sector, growing 20.4% YoY and 44.8% YoY, respectively.

Global: 1) In April, Japan's machine tool orders grew 45.1% YoY and declined slightly by 2.3% MoM (Exhibit 37). Excluding FX effects, growth in North America temporarily was 16.2% YoY (48.3% YoY in March), partly due to a high base. Growth in both Europe (+35.6% YoY vs. +21.9% YoY in March) and Japan (+43.4% YoY vs. +2.5% YoY in March, Exhibit 38) further accelerated. 2) In May, the manufacturing PMI in all major economies remained in the expansion range (US. 55.3; Eurozone 51.4; Japan 54.5; Exhibit 34 to Exhibit 36). 3) In April, Japan's robot exports volume continued its strong momentum, growing 40.7% YoY (+31.7% YoY in March, Exhibit 45). Despite a temporary decline in the U.S. (-5.8% YoY) due to a high base, growth in both China (+32.8% YoY vs. +25.6% YoY in March) and Europe (+68.3% YoY vs. +35.3% YoY in March) continued to accelerate. In March, the overall Japan robot order maintained strong momentum (+23% YoY and +10% MoM). We think it is driven by both a cyclical upturn and accelerated adoption enabled by Physical AI (see [here](#)).

DETAILS

EXHIBIT 1: Momentum Tracker

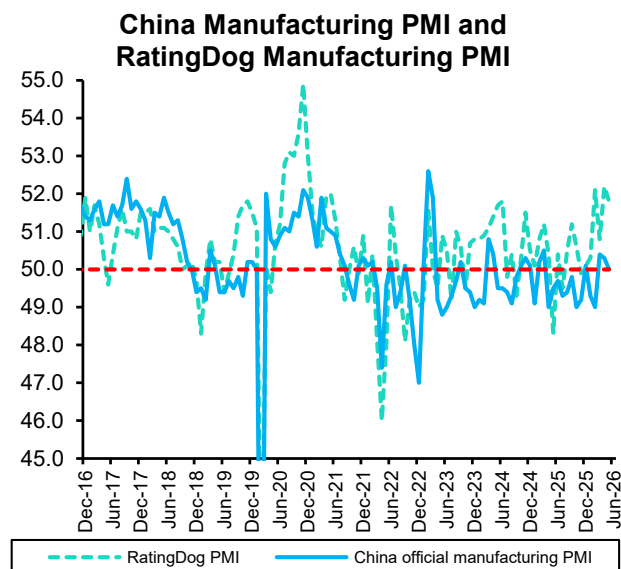
		Lastest period	Data type / unit	(a) Latest	(b) Previous	(c) YTD	(d) Previous FY	Momentum (a) vs. (b)	Momentum (c) vs. (d)
China	Macro Indicator								
	M1	Apr-26	YoY Growth	5.0%	5.1%	5.2%	3.7%	↓	↑
	PMI in Manufacturing	May-26	Index	50.0	50.3	49.8	49.6	↓	↑
	RatingDog Manufacturing PMI	May-26	Index	51.8	52.2	51.4	50.3	↓	↑
	Emerging Industries PMI	May-26	Index	52.9	57.4	52.5	50.9	↓	↑
	FAI - Overall	Apr-26	YTD Growth	-1.6%	1.7%	0.9%	1.4%	↓	↓
	FAI in Manufacturing	Apr-26	YTD Growth	1.2%	4.1%	2.8%	5.8%	↓	↓
	FAI in Equipment Purchase	Apr-26	YTD Growth	11.5%	13.9%	12.3%	15.5%	↓	↓
	Manufacturing Capacity Utilization	1Q26	Value (%)	73.6	74.9	73.6	74.4	↓	↓
	Industrial Profit Growth	Apr-26	YoY Growth	24.7%	15.8%	18.2%	0.6%	↑	↑
	Manufacturing Value-Add	Apr-26	YoY Growth	4.0%	6.0%	5.5%	6.3%	↓	↓
	PPI: All Industries	Apr-26	Index	101.3	99.6	99.4	98.1	↑	↑
	Floor Space: Started	Apr-26	YTD Growth	-22.1%	-20.2%	-22.1%	-22.6%	↓	↑
	Equipment Production								
	Excavator (Sales Volume)	Apr-26	YoY Growth	29.8%	26.4%	22.2%	17.0%	↑	↑
	Electric Motors	Apr-26	YoY Growth	0.1%	-1.1%	-2.0%	-0.5%	↑	↓
	Metal-cutting Machine Tool	Apr-26	YoY Growth	7.5%	4.7%	4.2%	9.7%	↑	↓
	Packaging Machinery	Apr-26	YoY Growth	21.2%	10.2%	-2.7%	18.2%	↑	↓
	Metal-shaping Machine Tool	Apr-26	YoY Growth	6.3%	-11.1%	3.5%	7.2%	↑	↓
	World	Multiple Units	Apr-26	YoY Growth	-50.6%	80.2%	35.2%	6.7%	↓
Locomotives		Apr-26	YoY Growth	30.6%	13.1%	52.4%	16.7%	↑	↑
Industrial Robots		Apr-26	YoY Growth	15.1%	24.4%	25.7%	28.0%	↓	↓
Purchasing Managers' Index (PMI)									
World		Apr-26	Index	52.6	51.3	51.7	50.3	↑	↑
United States		May-26	Index	55.3	54.5	53.2	51.7	↑	↑
Eurozone		May-26	Index	51.4	52.2	51.1	49.1	↓	↑
Japan		May-26	Index	54.5	55.1	53.1	49.0	↓	↑
Emerging Markets		Apr-26	Index	51.6	50.7	51.2	50.6	↑	↑
Manufacturing Utilization and Investment									
Japan Manufacturing Utilization		Mar-26	Index	103.7	105.0	104.6	102.5	↓	↑
US Manufacturing Utilization		Apr-26	Value (%)	75.7	75.3	75.4	75.3	↑	↑
US Industrial Equipment Investment		1Q26	YoY Growth	7.6%	8.1%	7.6%	6.8%	↓	↑
EU Manufacturing Utilization		1Q26	Value (%)	77.9	77.9	77.9	77.8	→	↑
Japan Machine Tool Orders									
Total Japan Machine Tool Orders		Apr-26	YoY Growth	45.1%	28.0%	30.9%	8.0%	↑	↑
from Japan		Apr-26	YoY Growth	43.4%	2.5%	13.5%	-0.2%	↑	↑
from China		Apr-26	YoY Growth	33.2%	27.2%	34.2%	17.1%	↑	↑
from Asia ex-China		Apr-26	YoY Growth	60.9%	22.2%	27.1%	5.6%	↑	↑
from EU		Apr-26	YoY Growth	35.6%	21.9%	16.5%	1.3%	↑	↑
from North America	Apr-26	YoY Growth	16.2%	48.3%	34.4%	19.0%	↓	↑	
Japan Industrial Robot Export Volume									
Total Industrial Robot Export	Apr-26	YoY Growth	40.7%	31.7%	32.6%	26.8%	↑	↑	
to China	Apr-26	YoY Growth	32.8%	25.6%	31.5%	37.6%	↑	↓	
to Asia ex-China	Apr-26	YoY Growth	88.6%	24.0%	35.1%	5.3%	↑	↑	
to US	Apr-26	YoY Growth	-5.8%	54.0%	19.7%	92.4%	↓	↓	
to EU	Apr-26	YoY Growth	68.3%	35.3%	45.2%	-8.8%	↑	↑	
Japan Automation Production and Order									
Servo Motor Production	Mar-26	YoY Growth	25.0%	17.9%	21.1%	0.3%	↑	↑	
PLC Production	Mar-26	YoY Growth	-6.6%	-13.3%	-15.0%	41.2%	↑	↓	
Reducer Production	Mar-26	YoY Growth	35.9%	8.6%	22.8%	-8.7%	↑	↑	
Robot Production	Mar-26	YoY Growth	21.1%	17.3%	-75.4%	19.6%	↑	↓	
Pneumatic Components Production	Mar-26	YoY Growth	27.2%	14.9%	21.5%	5.6%	↑	↑	
Robot Order	Mar-26	YoY Growth	23.1%	50.6%	41.9%	41.1%	↓	↑	

NBS, JMTBA, METI, Japan Ministry of Finance, US BEA, PMIII, Haver, Bloomberg, Wind, Bernstein analysis.

Source: Momentum Tracker

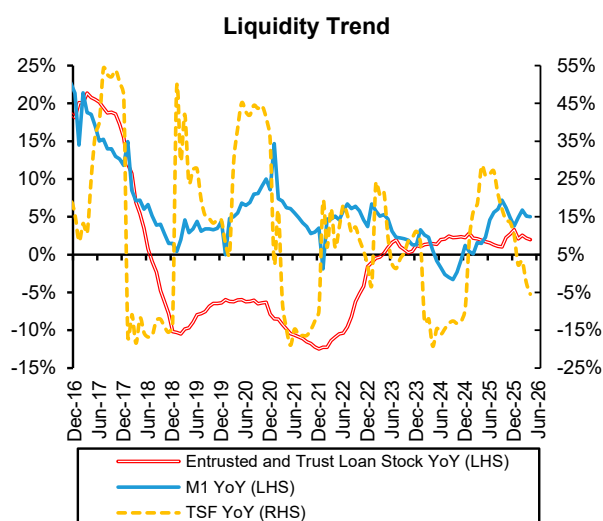
CHINA

EXHIBIT 2: China manufacturing PMI trend



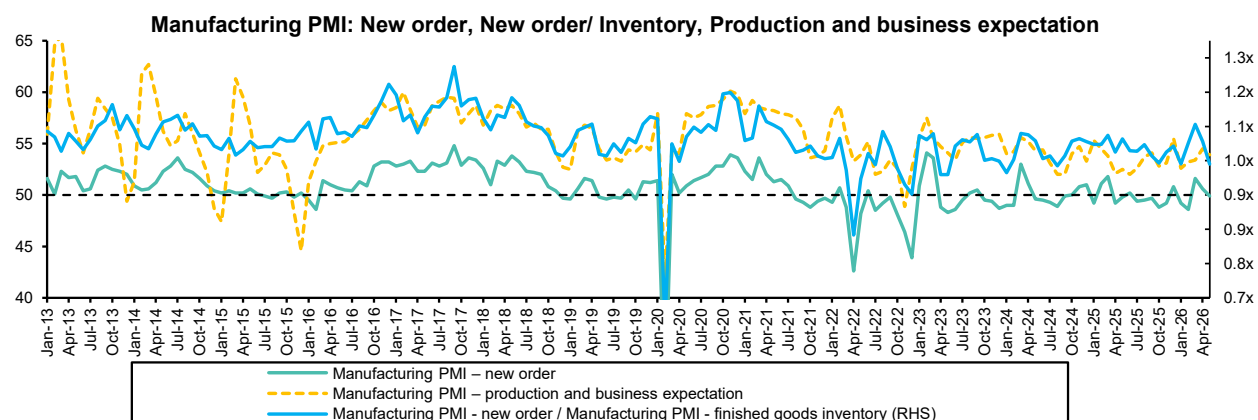
Source: Haver, Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 3: Liquidity tracker: M1, TSF and entrusted & trust loan trends

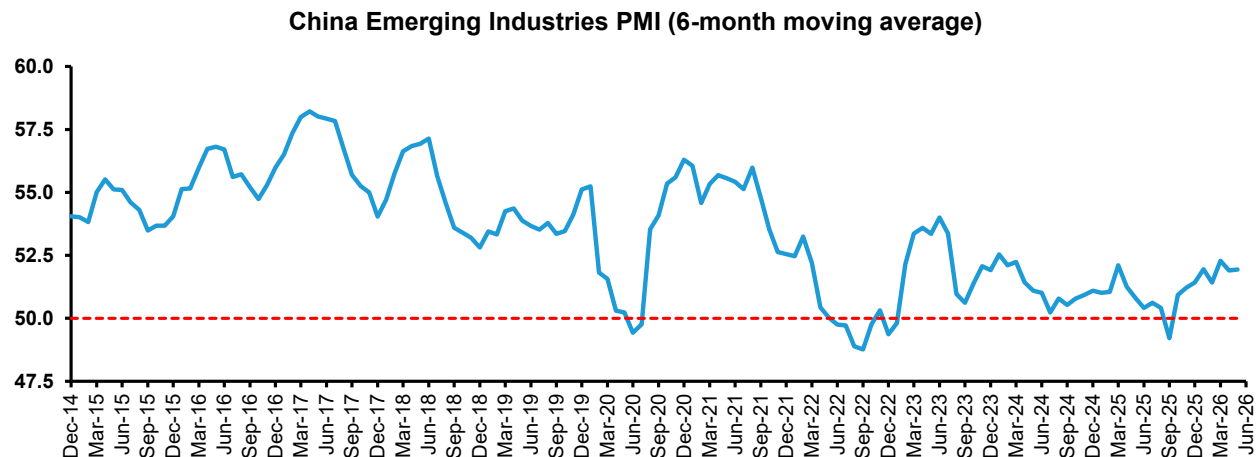


Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 4: China new order, new order/inventory, production and business expectation PMIs

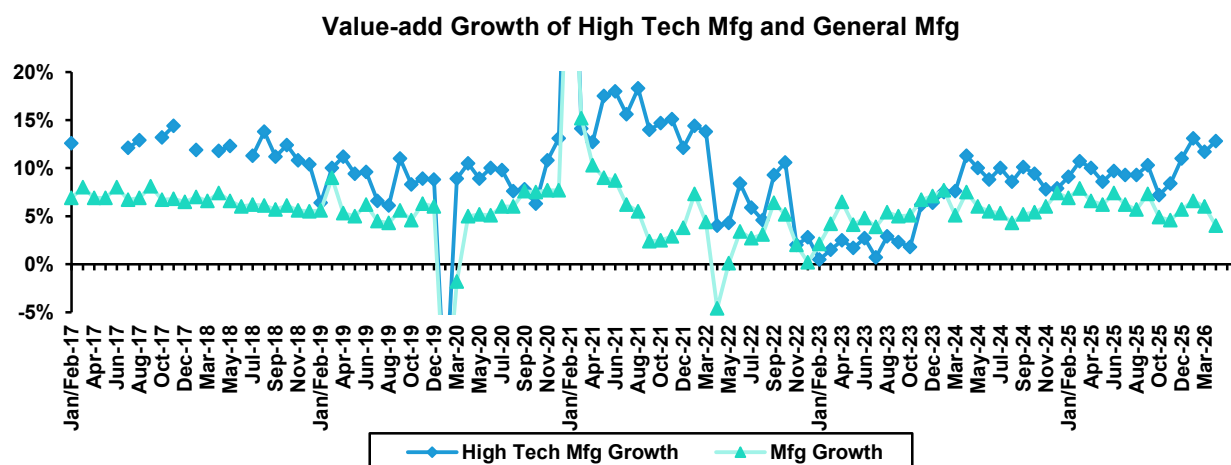


Source: Haver, China National Bureau of Statistics, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 5: **China emerging industries PMI (6-month moving average)**

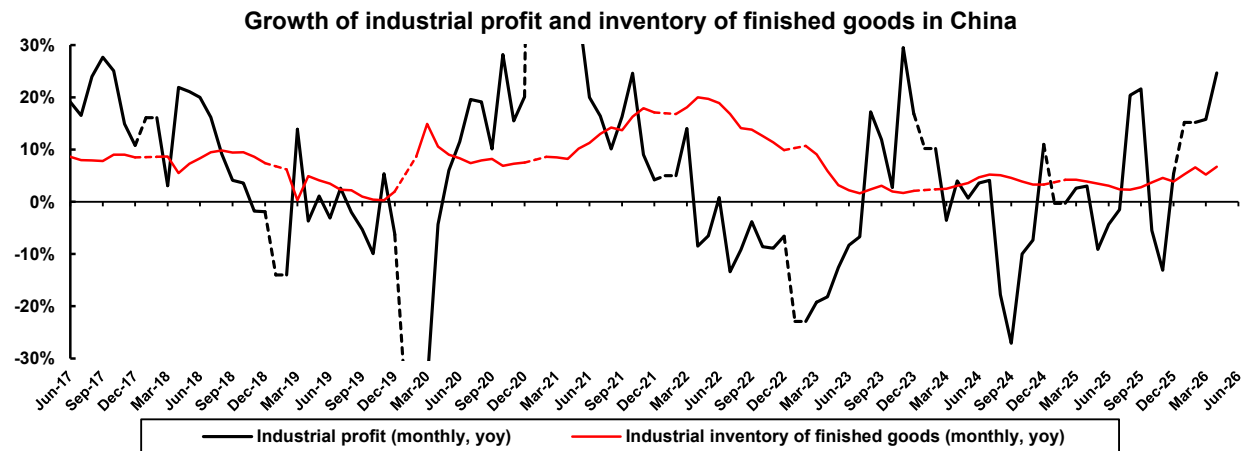
Note: The EPMI includes 280 sample companies in seven industries including energy conservation and environmental protection, new generation information technology, biotechnology, high-end equipment manufacturing, new energy, new materials, and new energy automobile industry. The EPMI survey is a monthly survey, which is greatly affected by seasonal factors and has large data fluctuations. The comprehensive index and sub-indices of EPMI currently released are seasonally adjusted data.

Source: Wind, Chinese Academy of Science and Technology for Development, PMIII, Bernstein analysis

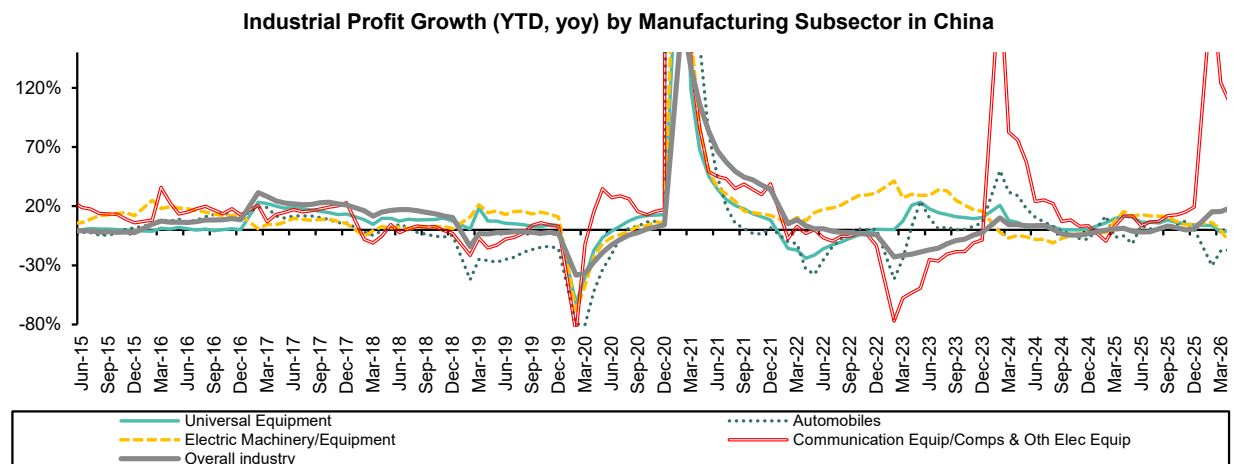
EXHIBIT 6: **Value-add growth of high technology manufacturing and general manufacturing**

Note: Pricing effect has been removed from the value-add growth rate.

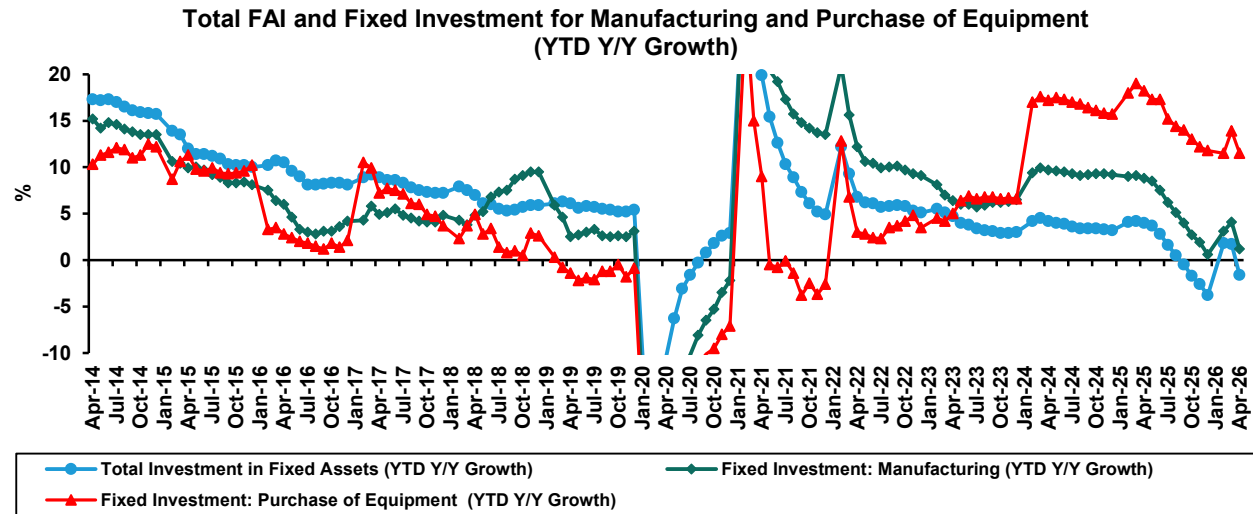
Source: NBS, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 7: **Growth of industrial profit and inventory of finished goods in China (yoy)**

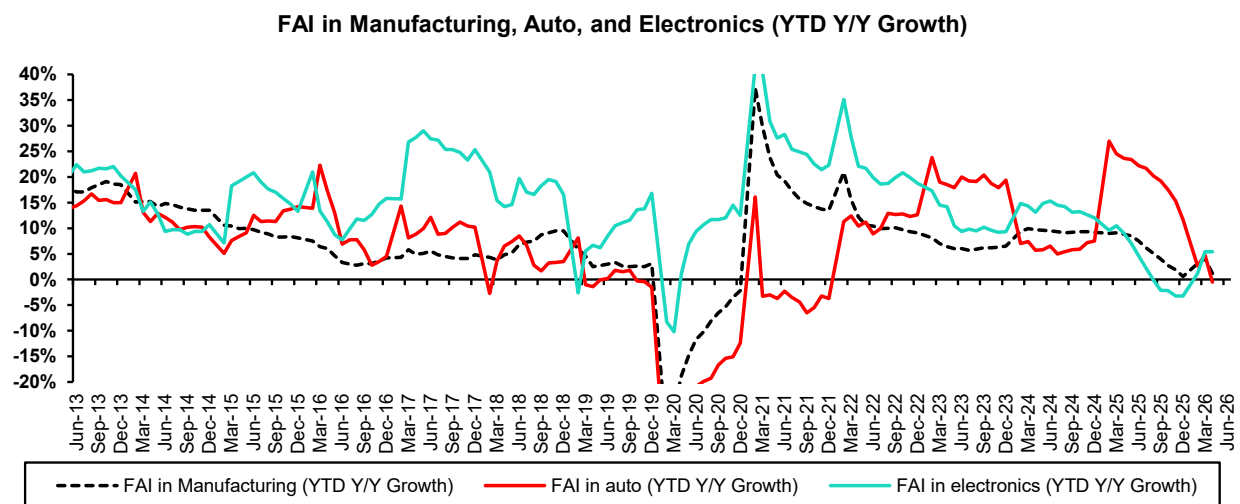
Source: Wind, National Bureau of Statistics of China, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 8: **Industrial profit trend**

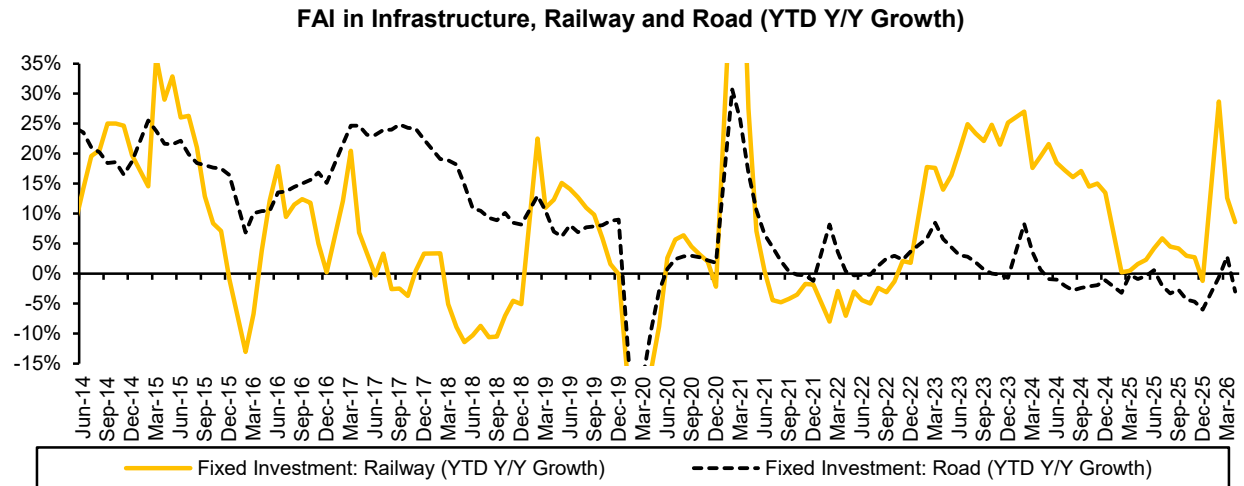
Source: NBS, Haver, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 9: **Total Fixed Asset Investment (FAI), FAI in manufacturing, and FAI in purchase of equipment.**

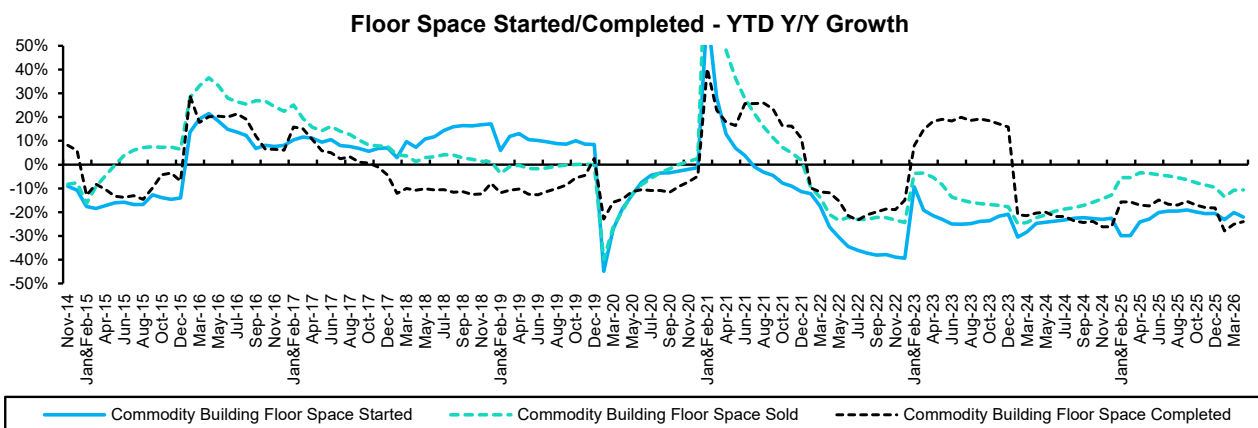
Source: National Bureau of Statistics (NBS), Haver, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 10: **FAI in manufacturing, auto, and electronics**

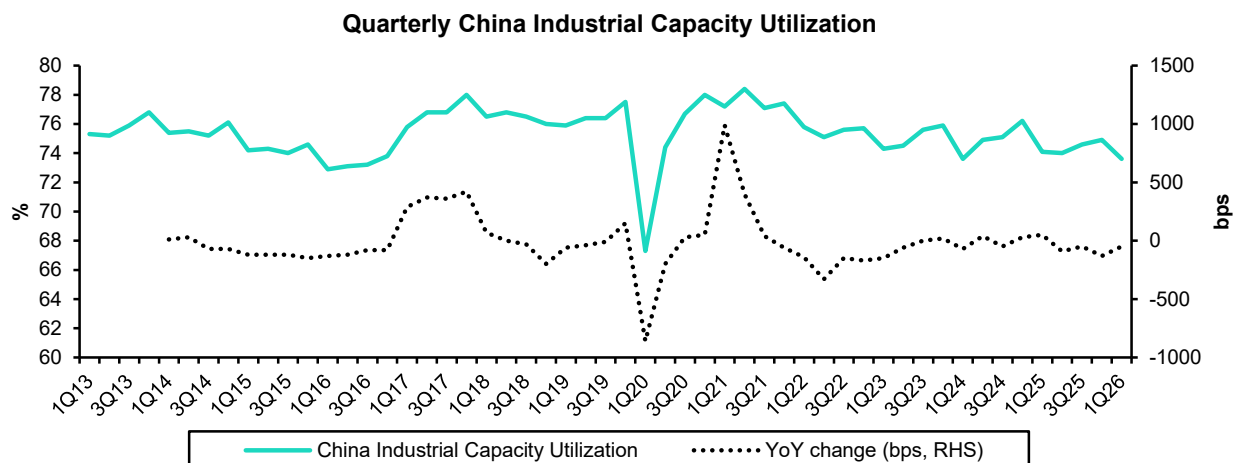
Source: NBS, Haver, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 11: **Infrastructure investment in China is still growing, especially Railway-related investments**

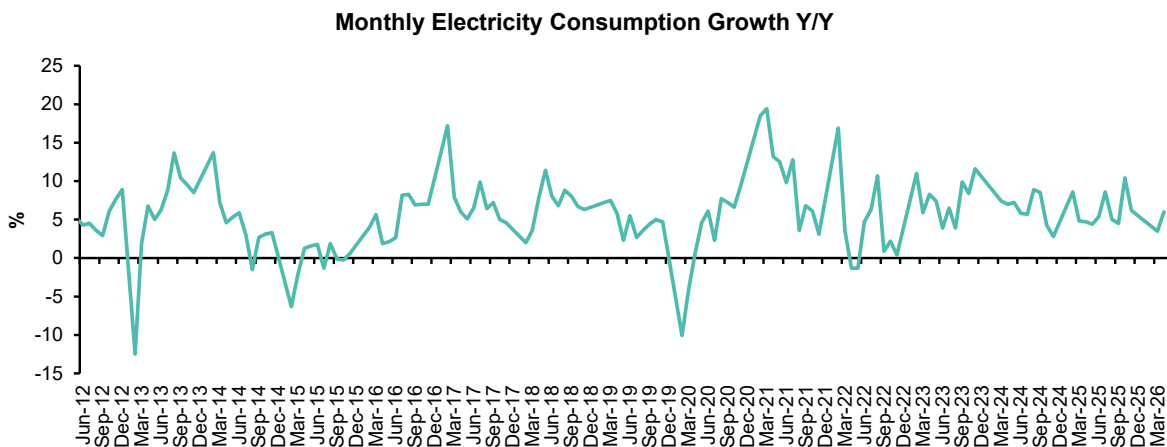
Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 12: **Real estate development trend**

Source: NBS, Haver, Bernstein analysis

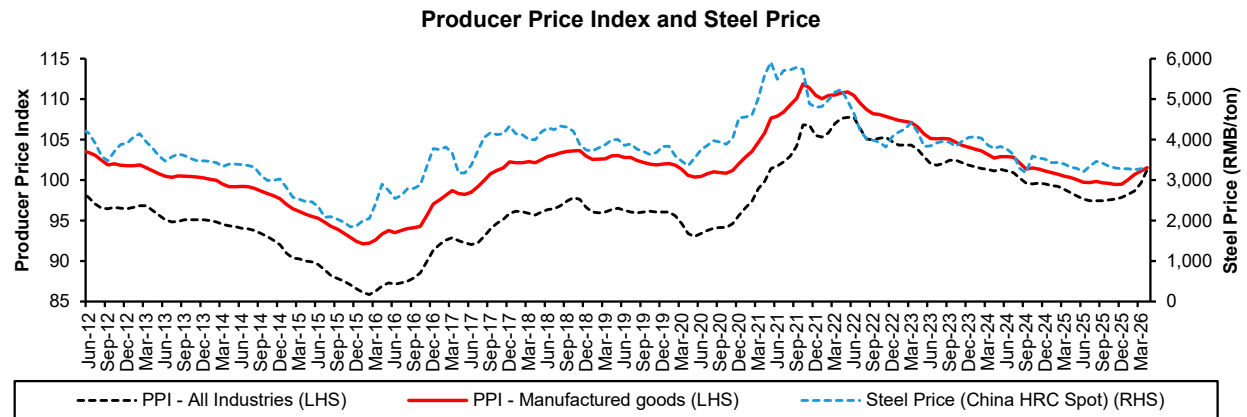
EXHIBIT 13: **China industrial capacity utilization by quarter**

Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 14: **Power consumption growth.**

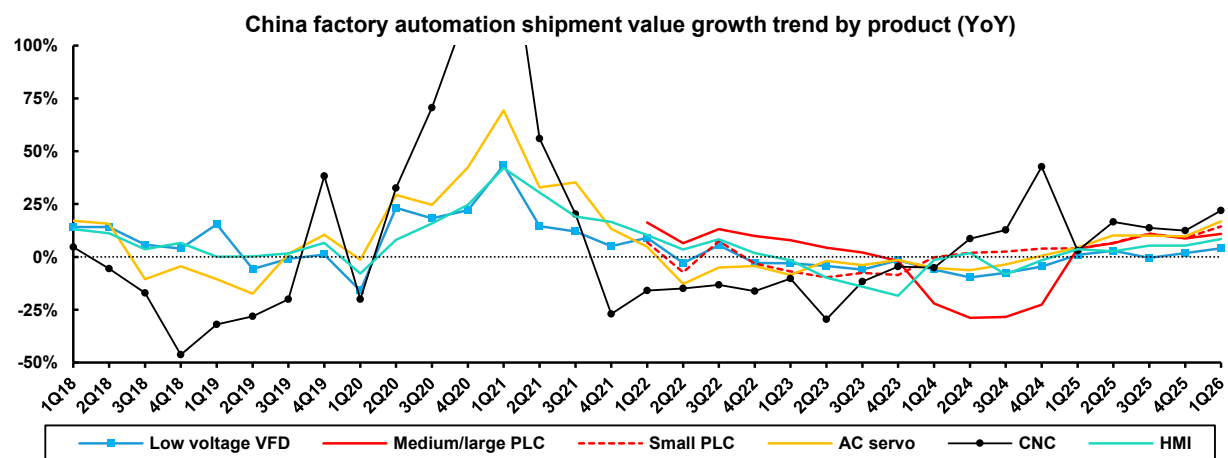
Note: No data in December and January

Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis.

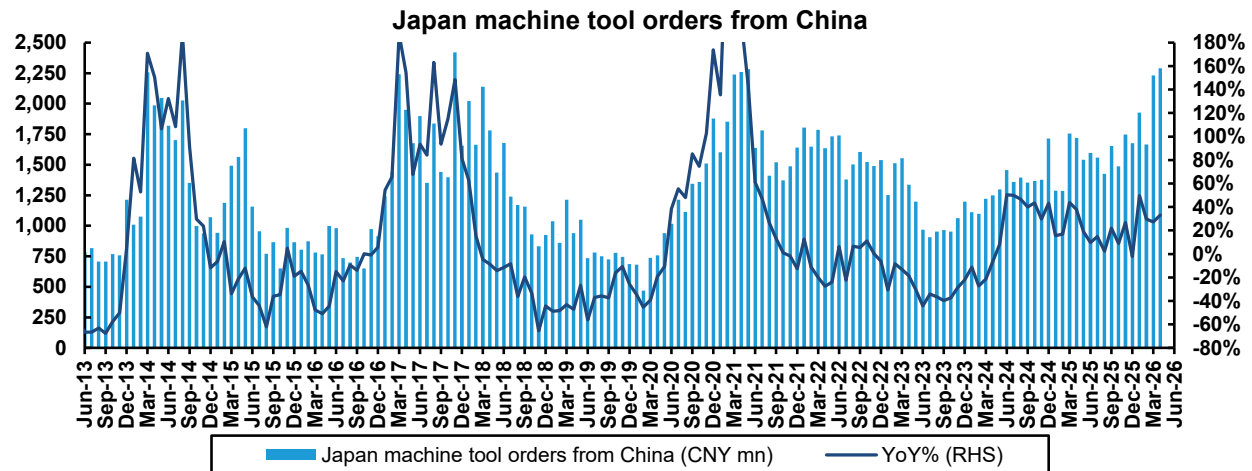
EXHIBIT 15: **PPI and steel price trends**

Note: Manufactured goods exclude mining, quarrying and raw materials.

Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis.

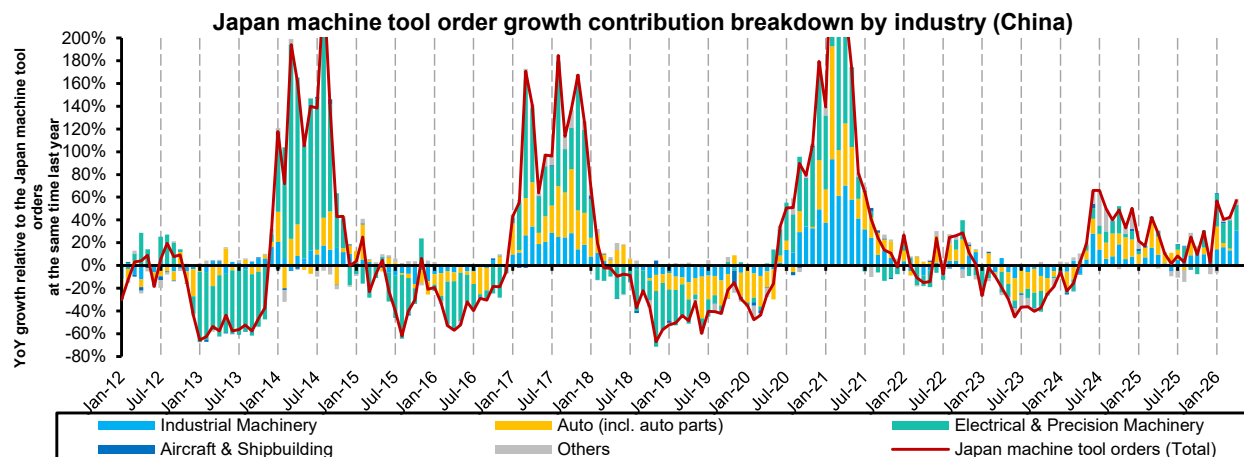
Equipment sales and productionEXHIBIT 16: **China factory automation shipment value growth trend by product (YoY)**

Source: MIR Databank, Bernstein analysis

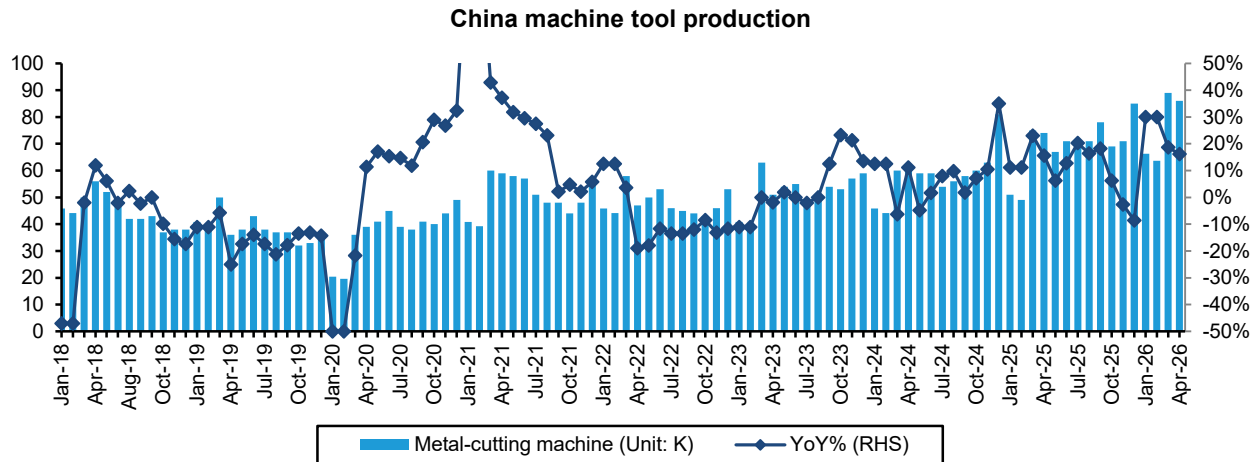
EXHIBIT 17: **Japan machine tool orders from China and Y/Y growth.**

Note: We adjusted the value to local currency to reflect the true demand.

Source: Bloomberg, JMTBA, Bernstein analysis

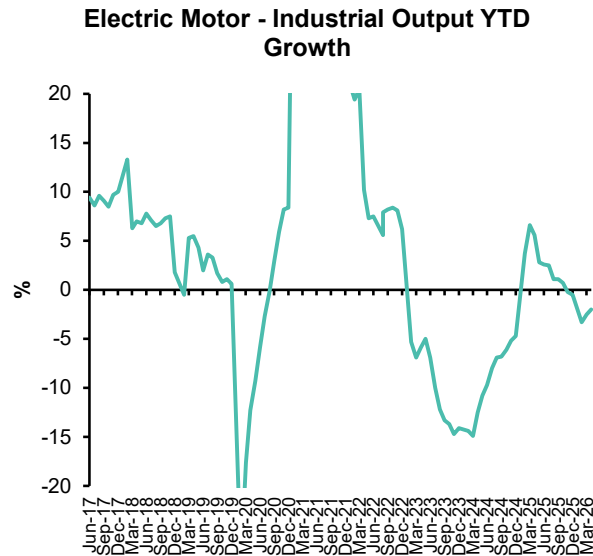
EXHIBIT 18: **Japan machine tool order growth contribution breakdown by industry (China)**

Source: JMTBA, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 19: **China metal-cutting machine tool production and Y/Y growth**

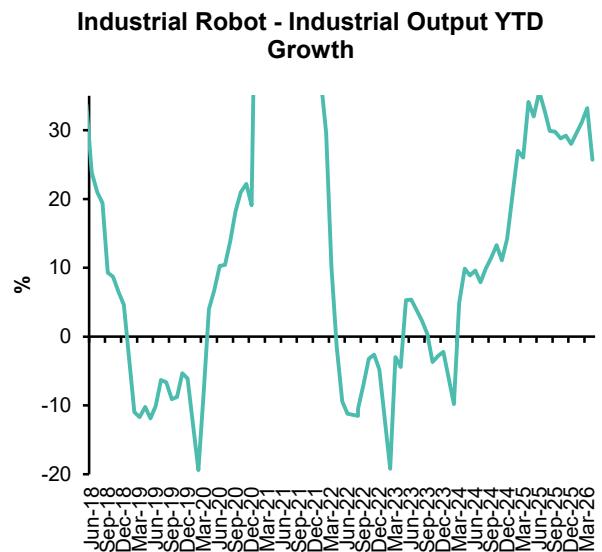
Note: The year-over-year percent changes of the monthly volume data do not always match the published year-over-year percent changes because the monthly volume data come from enterprises that are not the same from year to year whereas the published growth rates are calculated from enterprises that are the same from year to year.

Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 20: **Electric Motor: Industrial output YTD growth**

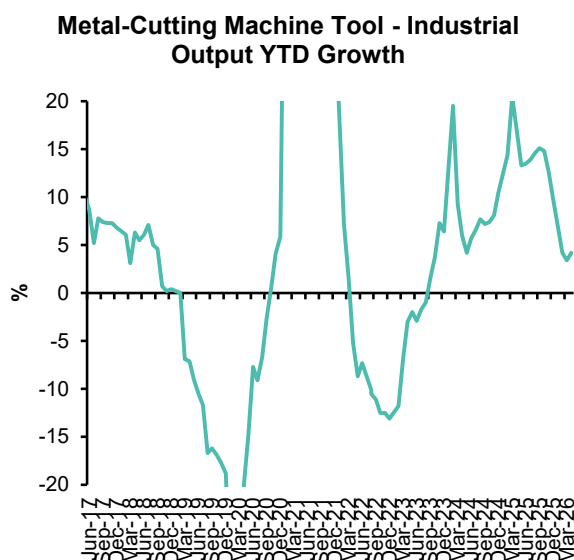
Note: The published year-to-year percent changes of the monthly YTD volume series are not always the same as the calculated year-to-year percent changes because the monthly YTD volume data come from enterprises that are not the same from year to year whereas the published growth rates are calculated from enterprises that are the same from year to year.

Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 21: **Industrial Robot: Industrial output YTD growth**

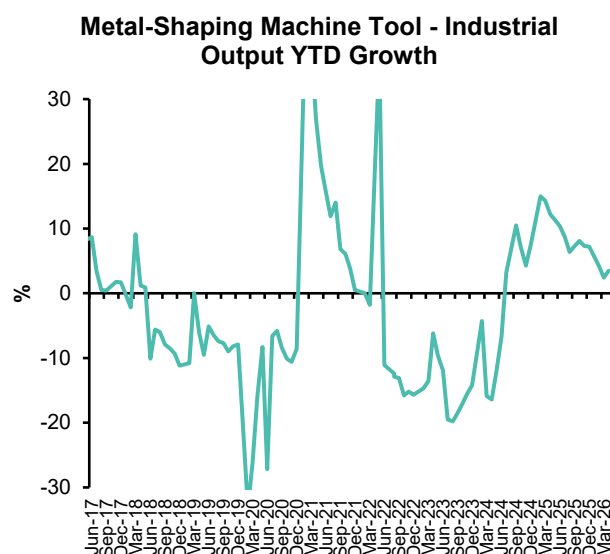
Note: The published year-to-year percent changes of the monthly YTD volume series are not always the same as the calculated year-to-year percent changes because the monthly YTD volume data come from enterprises that are not the same from year to year whereas the published growth rates are calculated from enterprises that are the same from year to year.

Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 22: Metal-cutting Machine Tool: Industrial output YTD growth

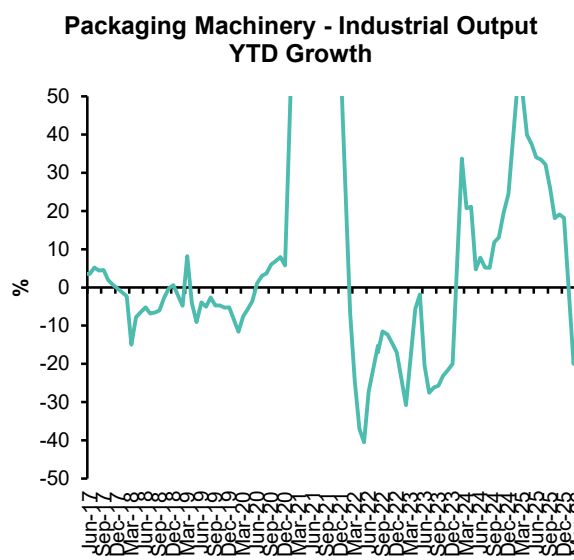
Note: The published year-to-year percent changes of the monthly YTD volume series are not always the same as the calculated year-to-year percent changes because the monthly YTD volume data come from enterprises that are not the same from year to year whereas the published growth rates are calculated from enterprises that are the same from year to year.

Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 24: Metal-shaping Machine Tool: Industrial output YTD growth

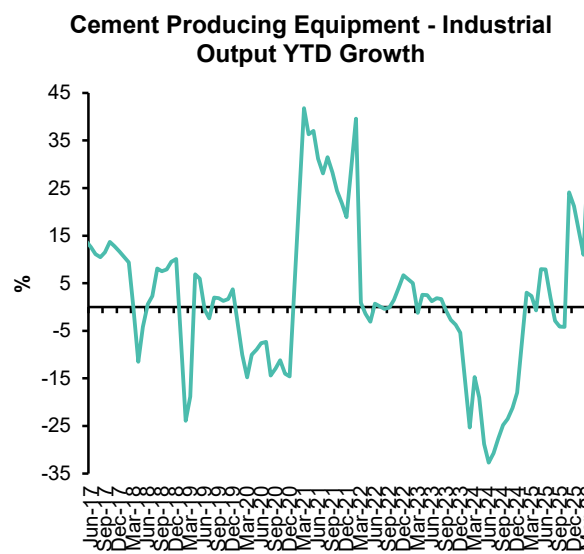
Note: The published year-to-year percent changes of the monthly YTD volume series are not always the same as the calculated year-to-year percent changes because the monthly YTD volume data come from enterprises that are not the same from year to year whereas the published growth rates are calculated from enterprises that are the same from year to year.

Source: Haver; Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 23: Packaging Machinery: Industrial output YTD growth

Note: The published year-to-year percent changes of the monthly YTD volume series are not always the same as the calculated year-to-year percent changes because the monthly YTD volume data come from enterprises that are not the same from year to year whereas the published growth rates are calculated from enterprises that are the same from year to year.

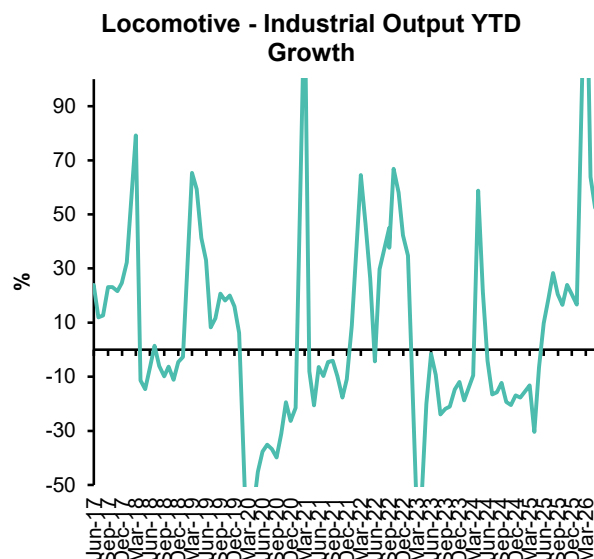
Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 25: Cement Producing Equipment: Industrial output YTD growth

Note: The published year-to-year percent changes of the monthly YTD volume series are not always the same as the calculated year-to-year percent changes because the monthly YTD volume data come from enterprises that are not the same from year to year whereas the published growth rates are calculated from enterprises that are the same from year to year.

Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis.

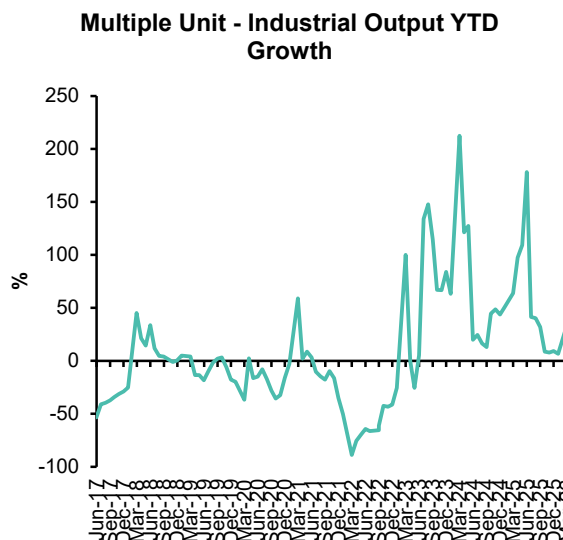
EXHIBIT 26: Locomotive: Industrial output YTD growth



Note: The published year-to-year percent changes of the monthly YTD volume series are not always the same as the calculated year-to-year percent changes because the monthly YTD volume data come from enterprises that are not the same from year to year whereas the published growth rates are calculated from enterprises that are the same from year to year.

Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis.

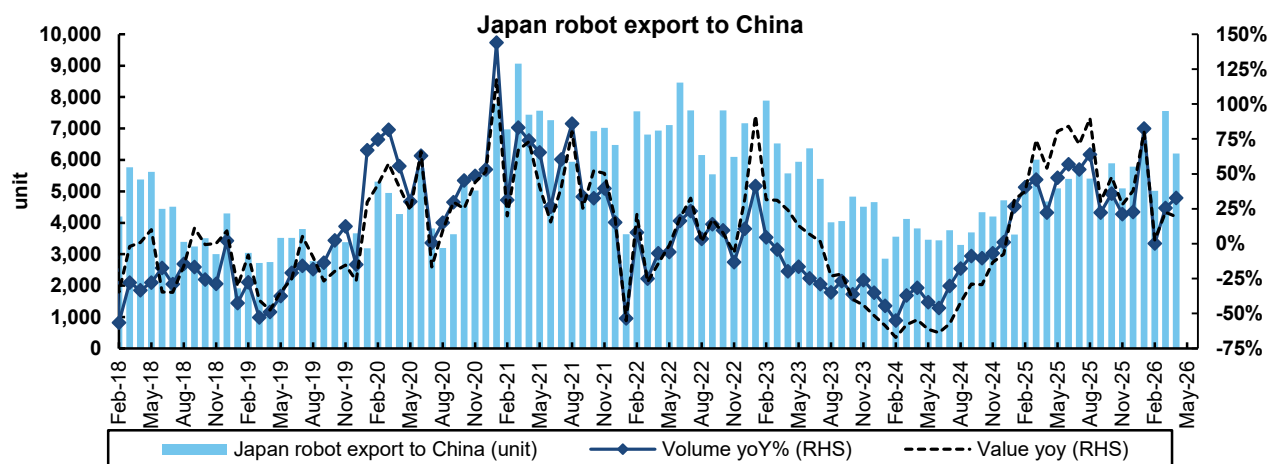
EXHIBIT 27: Multiple Unit: Industrial output YTD growth



Note: The published year-to-year percent changes of the monthly YTD volume series are not always the same as the calculated year-to-year percent changes because the monthly YTD volume data come from enterprises that are not the same from year to year whereas the published growth rates are calculated from enterprises that are the same from year to year.

Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis.

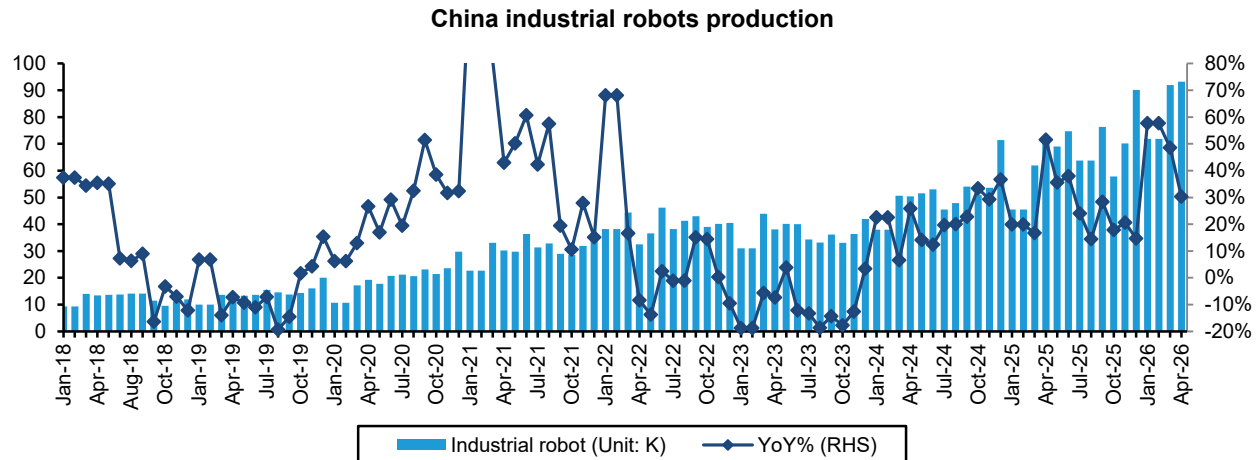
EXHIBIT 28: Growth rate of Japan robot export to China



Note: We adjusted the export value to China in local currency to reflect the true demand.

Source: Bloomberg, Trade Statistics of Japan, Bernstein analysis

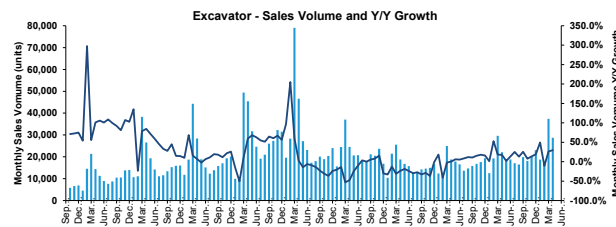
EXHIBIT 29: China industrial robot production and Y/Y growth



Note: The year-over-year percent changes of the monthly volume data do not always match the published year-over-year percent changes because the monthly volume data come from enterprises that are not the same from year to year whereas the published growth rates are calculated from enterprises that are the same from year to year. We estimates data in Jan. and Feb. as NBS reported the combined data.

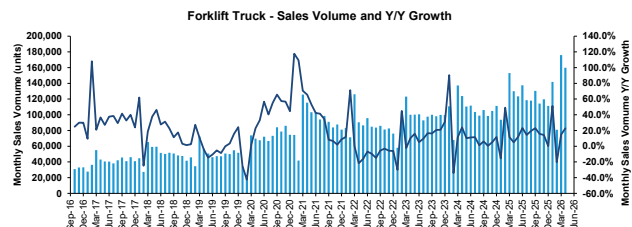
Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 30: Excavator: sales volume and Y/Y growth



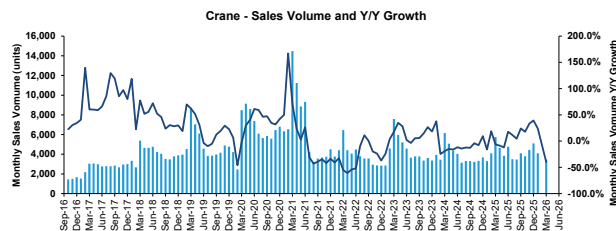
Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 31: Forklift Truck: sales volume and Y/Y growth



Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 32: Crane: sales volume and Y/Y growth

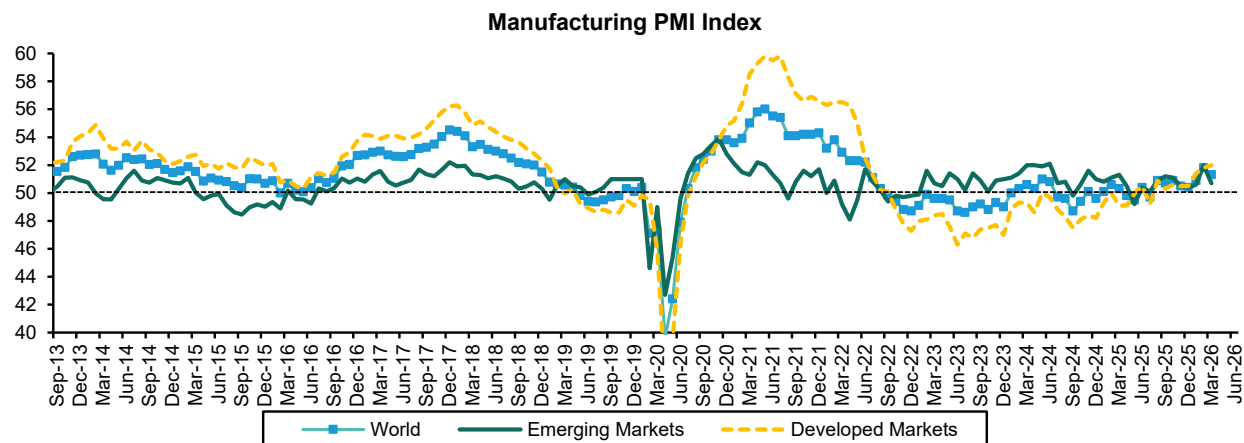


Note: The latest available data point is March 2026

Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis

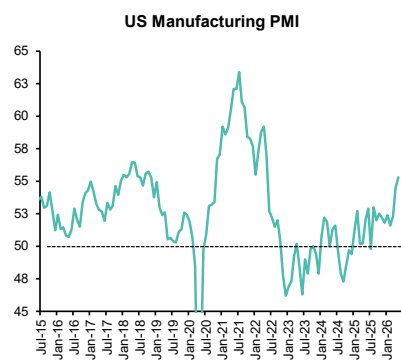
WORLD

EXHIBIT 33: **Manufacturing PMI for emerging markets, developed markets, and the world total**



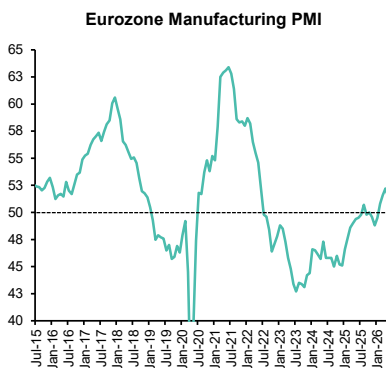
Source: Bloomberg, IHS Markit, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 34: **US Manufacturing PMI**



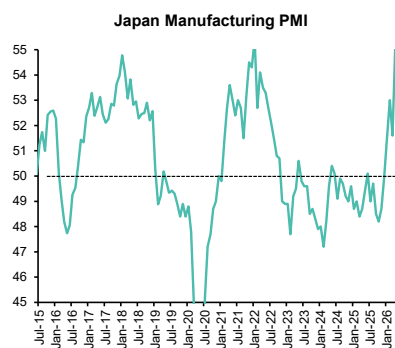
Source: Bloomberg, IHS Markit, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 35: **Eurozone Manufacturing PMI**

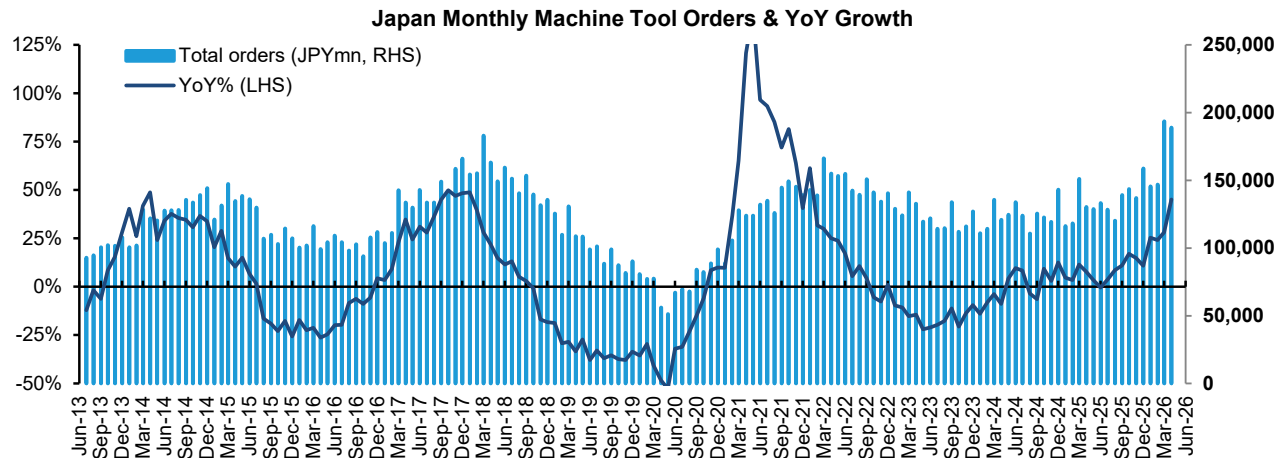


Source: Bloomberg, IHS Markit, Bernstein analysis.

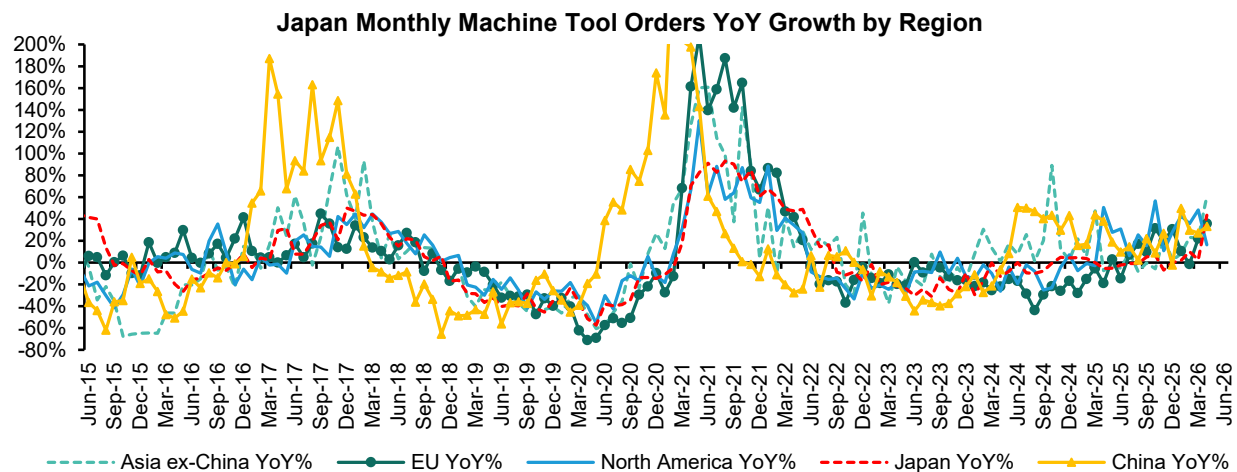
EXHIBIT 36: **Japan Manufacturing PMI**



Source: Bloomberg, IHS Markit, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 37: **Japan total machine tool order growth trend**

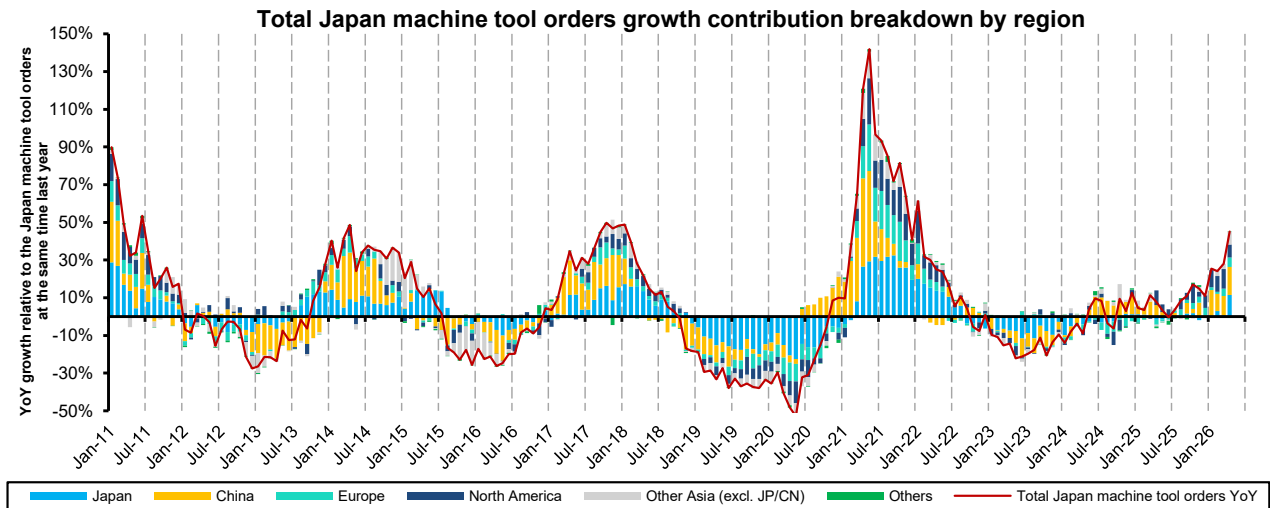
Source: JMTBA, Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 38: **Japan machine tool orders growth by region**

Note: We adjusted the order value from China, US, and EU to local currency to reflect the true demand

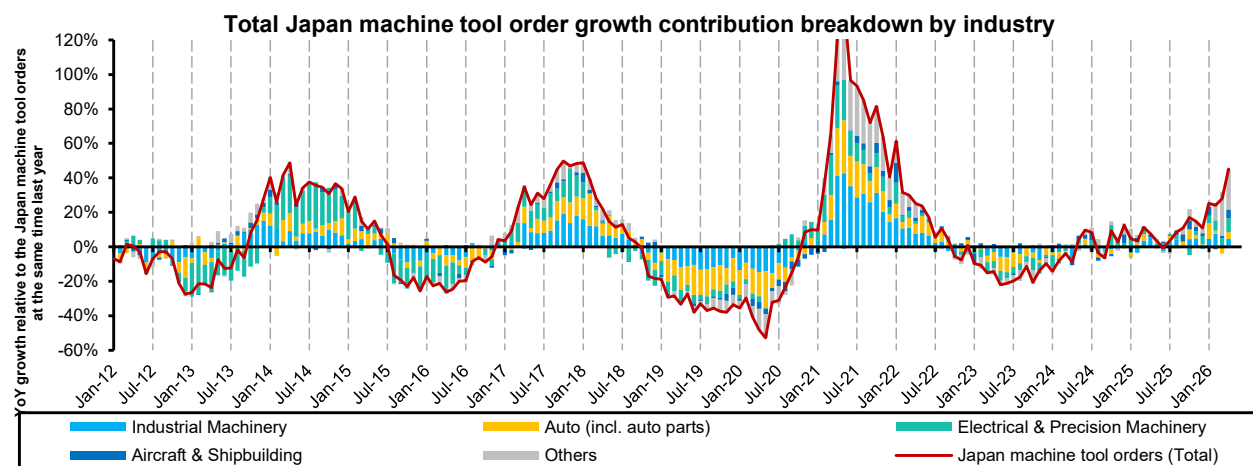
Source: JMTBA, Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 39: Japan machine tool orders growth contribution breakdown by region



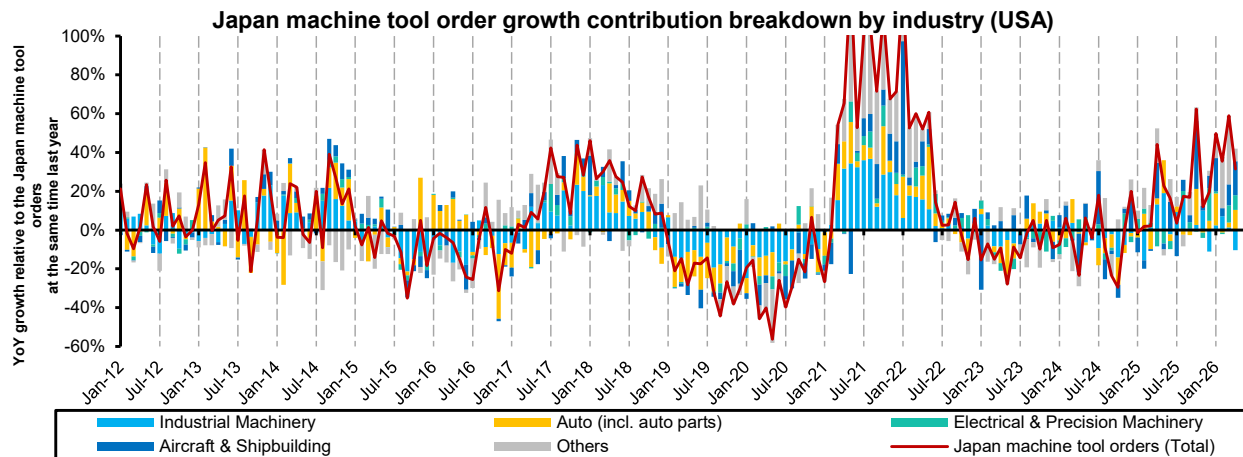
Source: JMTBA, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 40: Japan machine tool orders growth contribution breakdown by industry



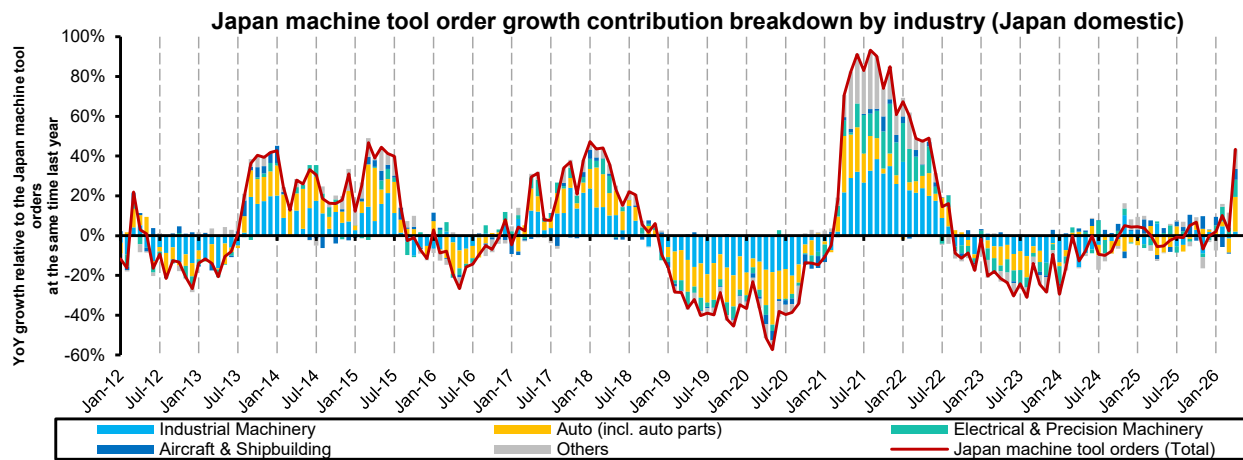
Source: JMTBA, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 41: Japan machine tool order growth contribution breakdown by industry (USA)



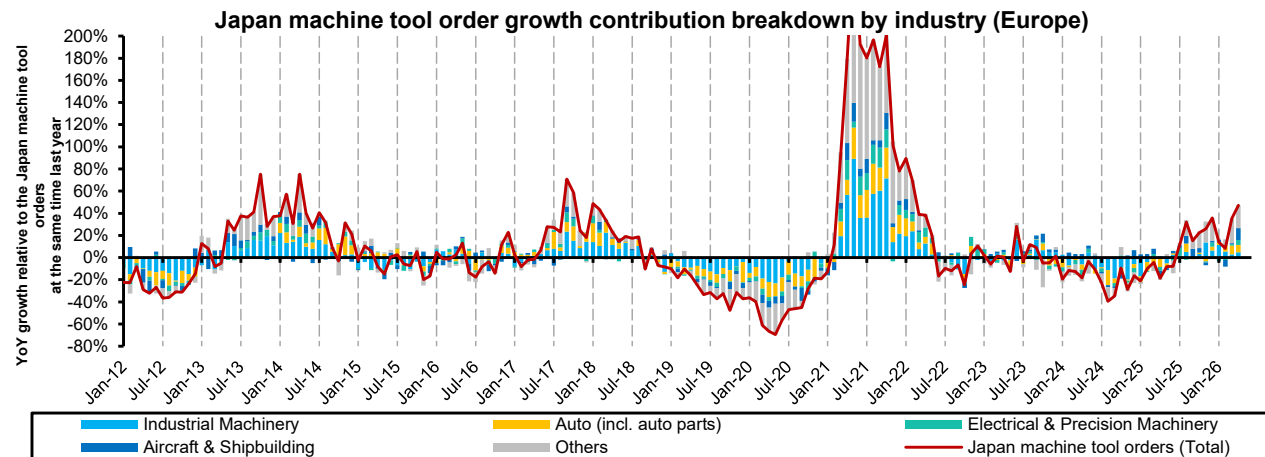
Source: JMTBA, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 42: Japan machine tool order growth contribution breakdown by industry (Japan domestic)



Source: JMTBA, Bernstein analysis

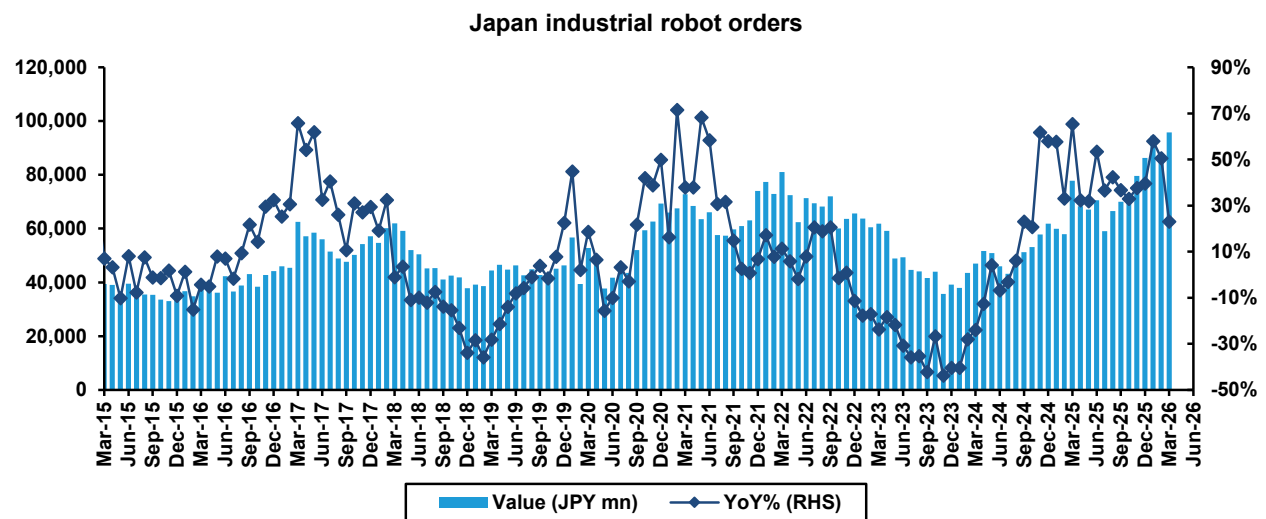
EXHIBIT 43: Japan machine tool order growth contribution breakdown by industry (Europe)



Note: Europe include non-EU countries. The latest data point is Jan. 2026.

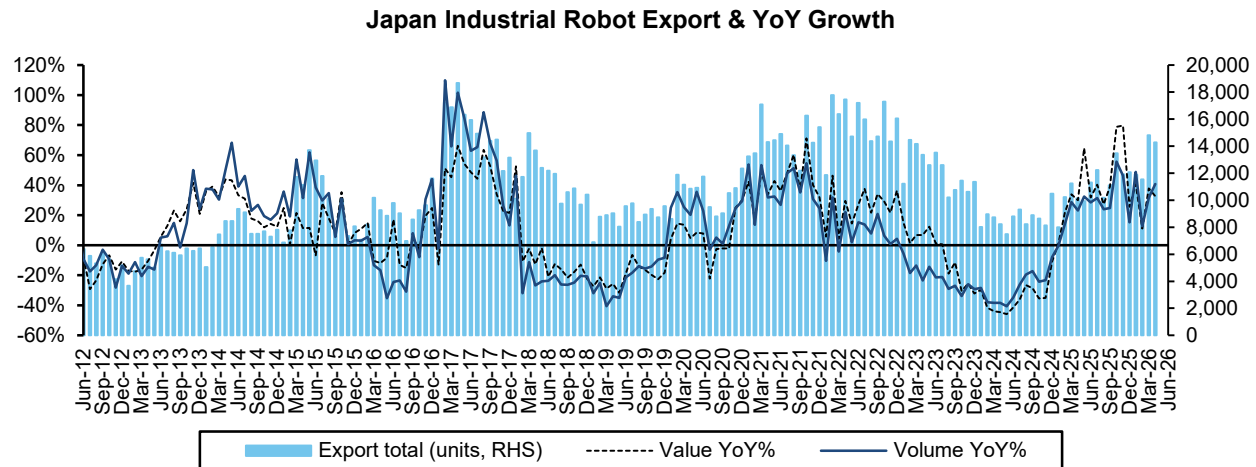
Source: JMTBA, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 44: Japan industrial robot orders growth trend



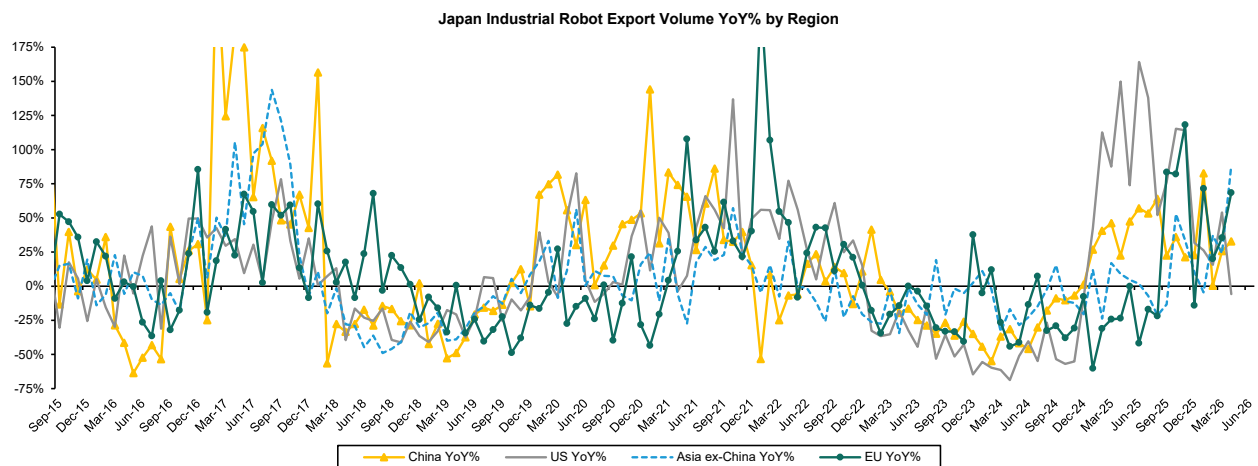
Source: Cabinet Office (Government of Japan), Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 45: Japan industrial robot export value and volume growth

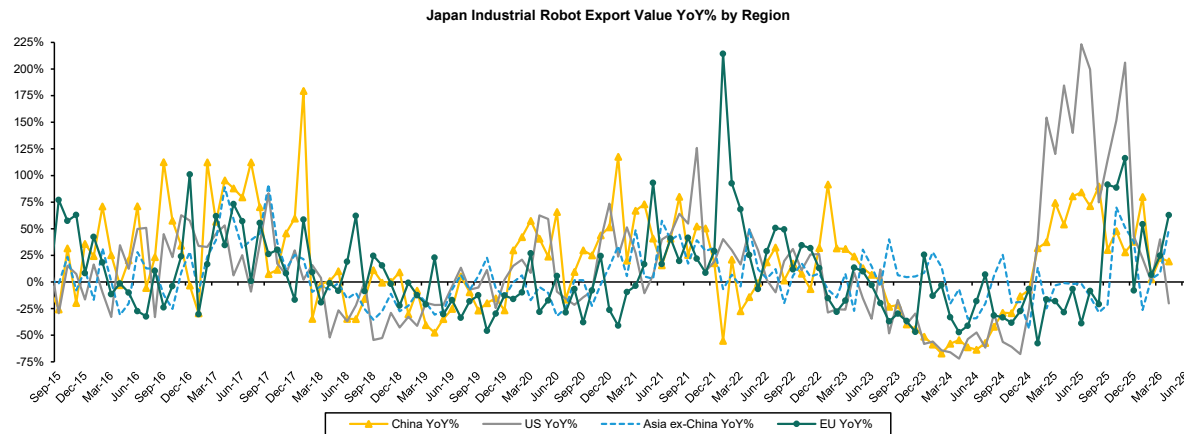


Source: Japan Ministry of Finance, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 46: Japan industrial robot export volume growth by region

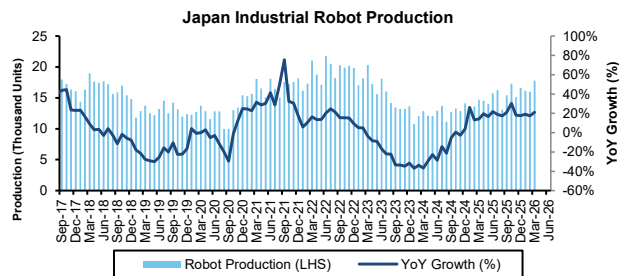


Source: Japan Ministry of Finance; Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis.

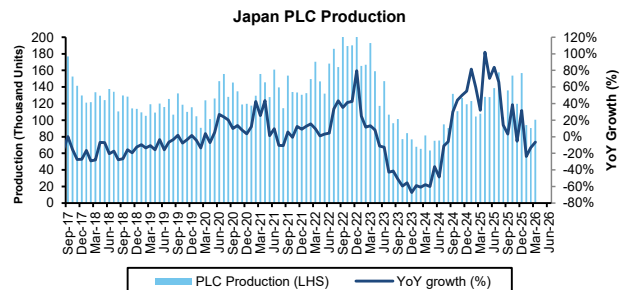
EXHIBIT 47: Japan industrial robot export value growth by region

Note: We adjusted the export value to China, US, and EU to local currency to reflect the true demand.

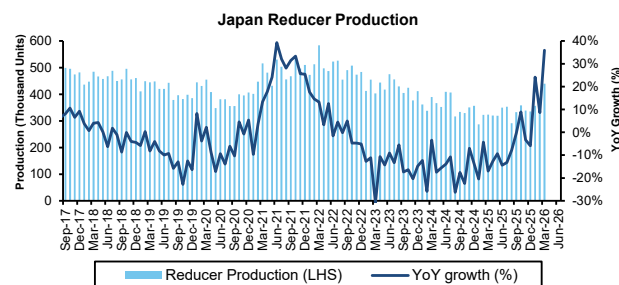
Source: Japan Ministry of Finance; Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 48: Japan - Robot production

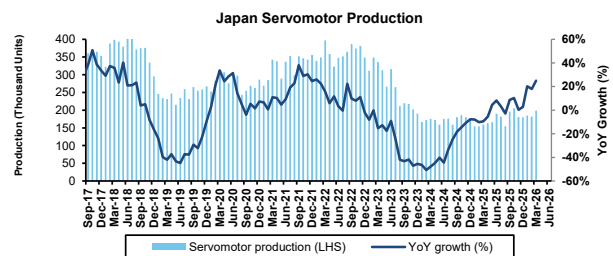
Source: Ministry of Economy, Trade, and Industry (METI) of Japan, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 49: Japan - PLC production

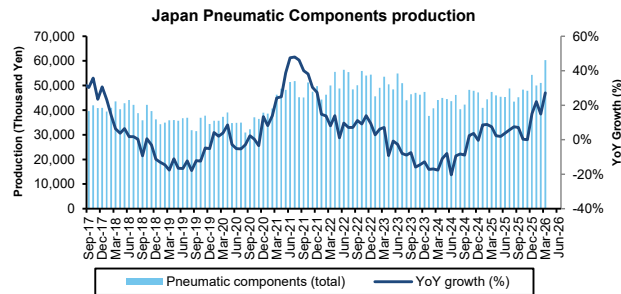
Source: METI, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 50: Japan - Reducer production

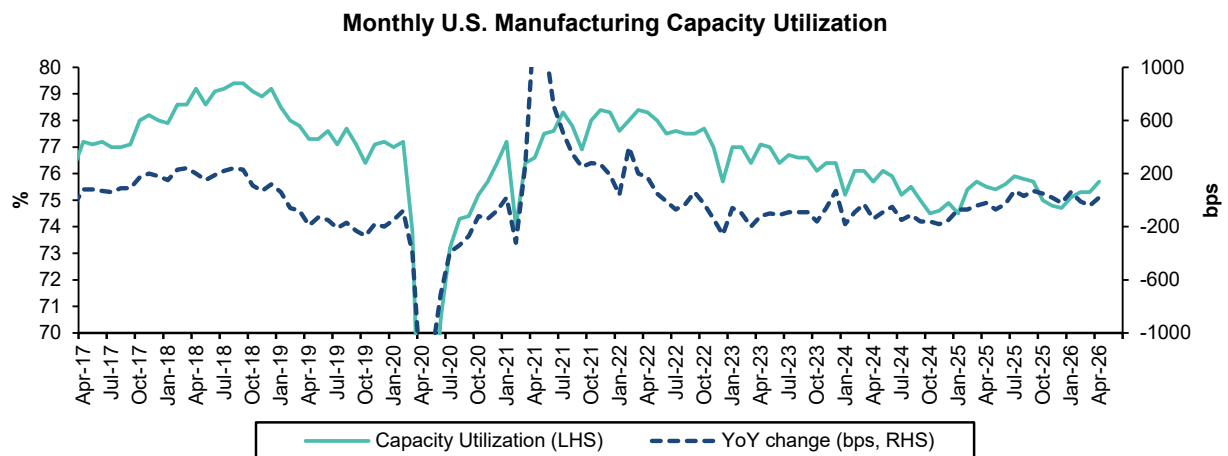
Source: METI, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 51: Japan - Servomotor production

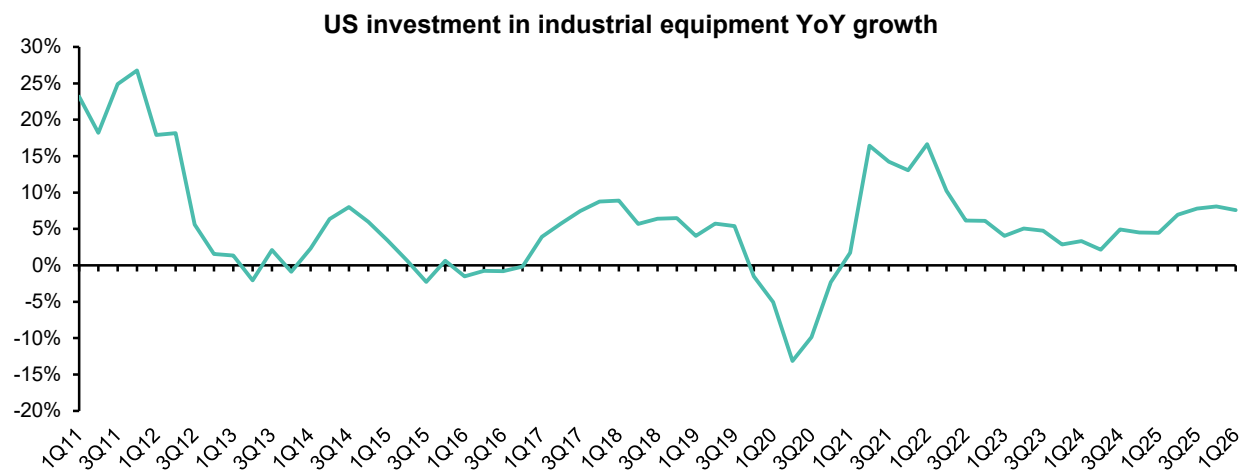
Source: METI, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 52: **Japan - Pneumatic Components production**

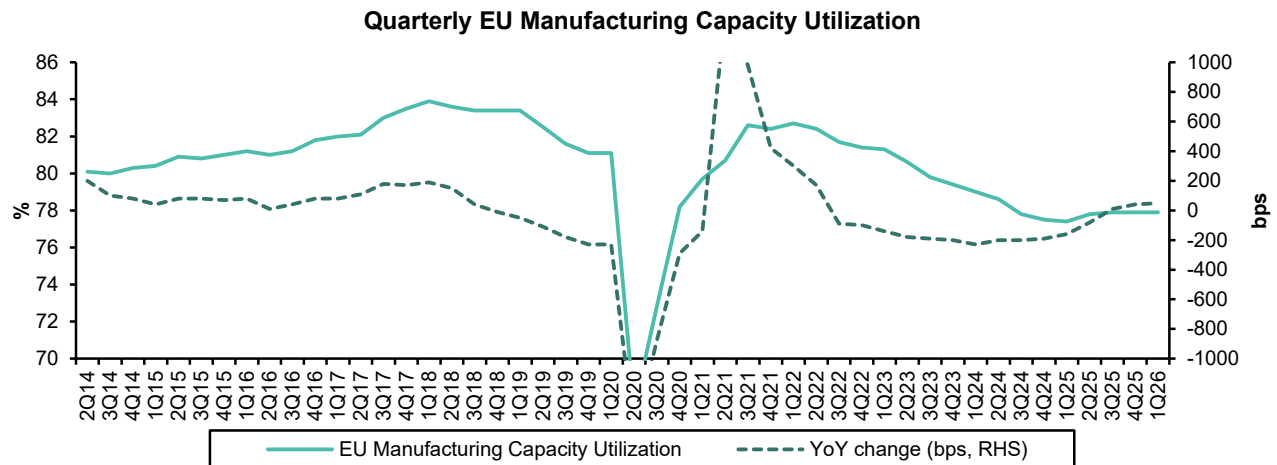
Source: METI, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 53: **Historical U.S. manufacturing capacity utilization by month**

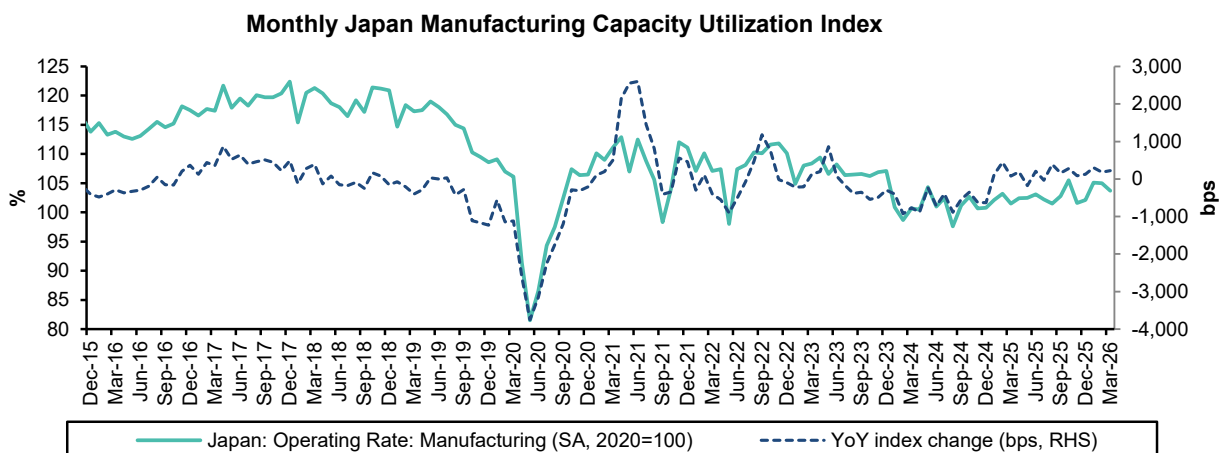
Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 54: **US YoY investment growth in industrial equipment**

Source: Haver; US BEA; Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 55: **Historical EU manufacturing capacity utilization by quarter**

Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 56: **Historical Japan manufacturing capacity utilization index by month**

Source: Haver, Bernstein analysis.

INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

Reiterate Outperform for Keyence, FANUC, Inovance, SMC, AirTAC, Cognex, Hikvision, Han's Laser, IPG Photonics, and Harmonic Drive; Market-Perform for Estun.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	Cur	29 May 2026	Price Target	TTM	Reported EPS				Reported P/E (x)		
			Closing Price		Rel. Perf.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
CGNX (Cognex)	O	USD	65.85	75.00	86.1%	USD	0.67	1.46	1.62	98.3	45.1	40.8
6954.JP (Fanuc)	O	JPY	7,892.00	7,000.00	61.4%	JPY	178.47	207.32	193.15	44.2	38.1	40.9
002008.CH (Hans Laser)	O	CNY	131.85	130.00	426.0%	CNY	1.15	2.15	2.48	114.7	61.2	53.2
IPGP (IPG Photonics)	O	USD	114.52	125.00	42.6%	USD	0.73	1.30	2.24	156.9	88.3	51.1
6861.JP (Keyence)	O	JPY	80,110	86,000	(10.7)%	JPY	1,835.63	2,248.48	2,494.78	43.6	35.6	32.1
300124.CH (Inovance)	O	CNY	73.96	82.00	(35.1)%	CNY	1.87	2.19	2.65	39.6	33.7	27.9
002415.CH (Hikvision)	O	CNY	30.56	40.00	(38.9)%	CNY	1.55	1.79	1.98	19.8	17.1	15.4
6324.JP (HDSI)	O	JPY	7,800.00	7,800.00	95.2%	JPY	16.99	57.37	79.51	459.1	136.0	98.1
1590.TT (AirTAC)	O	TWD	1,400.00	1,500.00	2.5%	TWD	41.97	53.26	55.38	33.4	26.3	25.3
6273.JP (SMC)	O	JPY	69,110	78,000	(15.0)%	JPY	2,640.86	2,975.39	3,256.00	26.2	23.2	21.2
002747.CH (Estun)	M	CNY	27.72	26.00	(3.3)%	CNY	0.05	0.31	0.32	554.4	90.2	85.7
2715.HK (Estun)	M	HKD	16.84	17.26	NA	CNY	0.05	0.31	0.32	336.8	54.8	52.1
SPX			7,580.06									
JPL			2,580.62									
ASIA			2,010.20									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

6954.JP, 6861.JP, 6273.JP base year is 2026;

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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Underperform	SELL	12.6%	14.9%

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